



Prof. S. Sadagopan with his wife

ernment wanted me to do that.”

Prof. Sadagopan was involved with several large-scale IT initiatives in India, including:

- RTGS from the Reserve Bank of India
- Algo Trading from the National Stock Exchange
- UPI from NPCI
- Core banking in several public sector banks, including the Bank of India, Canara Bank, and the Indian Overseas Bank
- Post Office Bank
- SAP implementation at leading public sector companies, including Indian Oil, BHEL, NTPC, and private sector companies, including Tata Motors, Ashok Leyland, and Maruti Udyog

Large-scale projects that have a global impact include:

- Chairing MOSIP (Modular Open Source Identity Platform) that built an open source version of the Citizen Identity project (like AAD-HAAR), during 2017-2021; MOSIP is

currently being implemented in about a dozen countries

- As the Mentor Director involved in setting up the Myanmar International Institute of Information Technology (MIIT), Mandalay; during 2016-2021, this institute was sponsored by the Ministry of External Affairs of the Indian government and the government of Myanmar

- Conceptualising and executing the hugely successful IITB

- upGrad Data Science program, the largest online education program in India during 2016-2021

- MINRO (Machine Intelligence and Robotics) Centre funded by the government of Karnataka during 2014-2021

The professor has been serving on the boards of several higher educational institutes, including IITs at Gwalior, Delhi, Bhubaneshwar, Dharwad, Kottayam, Chennai (IITDM - Kancheepuram) as well as MAHE, Jain University, Sai University, Dayanand Sahar and RV University. He was a member of the Karnataka Knowledge Commission and Chief Minister’s Vision Groups on High Education and IT.

He has served on the boards of several corporations, including Bharat Electronics, BEML, Bank of India, National Mineral Development Corporation, NLC, National Stock Exchange, Indian Overseas Bank, NESL, Tata Elxsi, VisualSoft, Coemtp, and Informatics.

The professor is also a fellow of the UK’s IET (formerly IEE), Computer Society of India, and Institution of Engineers (India). Apart from that, he is a senior member of the IEEE and ACM. Prof. Sadagopan’s research work has appeared in several international journals, including IEEE Transactions, the European Journal of Operational Research, the Journal of Optimization Theory and Applications, Naval Research Logistics Simulation and Decision Support Systems. Moreover, he served as a visiting faculty at the Rutgers University, USA, and the Asian Institute of Technology, Bangkok.

He was actively involved with the startup ecosystem in India. “We started teaching about entrepreneurship long back in the 70s when the word ‘startup’ was not so popular. In the late 80s and the early 90s, the startup ecosystem gradually started growing. I have been mentoring dozens of startup companies, many founded by my former students, in the past two decades. I have also been involved with VCs and venture funds as a part of their startup investment committee. I helped many startups through that engagement.”

Being a people person

Prof. Sadagopan describes himself as a ‘people person’ as most of his activities are people-centric. He further explains, “I travel a lot because I visit my friends often and, in the process, I ended up going to 40 countries and hundreds of towns. But I never travel only to visit a place.”

“I do not pursue any activity that normally people associate with hobbies. I hardly play any games. However, I read lots of books, but honestly speaking, I never read a single novel or any popular magazine. I have not watched any movie in the last 50 to 60 years, except a biopic of Mahatma Gandhi. I have completely zero knowledge about